

4, Adjustments to the Definition of Class Society

Reflecting on the systemic ideological deception prevalent over the past decade evokes a profound sense of indignation. It has become unprecedentedly clear to me the sheer magnitude of atrocities an unchecked state apparatus is capable of committing—a reality that was previously unimaginable.

The most ludicrous aspect is that the ones who truly sentenced these states to death theoretically were none other than Marx and Engels, the revered founding fathers of scientific socialism.

For example, a highly classic issue is the question of the "**primary factor of production**" (首位生产要素), which is used to explain why humanity experiences different stages of class societies.

Since the emergence of surplus products and subsequent class differentiation in human society, along with the development of **productive forces** (生产力), three factors of production have successively leaped to the premier position among all factors: labor, land, and capital.

*(A detail must be pointed out here: for **early states** / 早期国家, the primary object of exploitation should be more precisely articulated as "primary labor" / 初级劳动力 rather than just "labor." The former emphasizes sheer physical strength. Because, in every sense, knowledge itself is a component of labor. We can recall that for Egypt and Mesopotamia during the Bronze Age and earlier, although there was no shortage of slaves engaged in technical work, the advanced knowledge and production techniques of that era were still primarily in the hands of the **priestly class** / 祭司阶级, secular rulers, and freemen. If we roughly divide labor into primitive labor—i.e., physical strength—plus intellectual capital—i.e., knowledge—the situation becomes much clearer).*

(This is precisely why the term "factors of production" / 生产要素 is used instead of "means of production" / 生产资料. Because in the Marxist context, labor does not belong to the means of production, but is merely a factor of production; whereas land and capital are encompassed by both).

What exactly is meant by the "premier position" (首要位置)? This is indeed not particularly easy to explain for someone like me who lives in a bureaucratic society (官僚社会). My country has not been in a typical class society for 14 centuries; after all, in the land where I live, "*nothing under heaven is greater than official authority*" (天大地大不如官大).

Therefore, based on my shallow understanding, the so-called "premier position" encompasses at least three connotations. *(If someone more knowledgeable reads my records in the future, they can correct me!)*

First, a certain factor of production occupying the premier position implies that its contribution to social production is the greatest.

Second, a certain factor of production occupying the premier position implies that the **relations of production** (生产关系) must be adjusted around it as the center. Consequently, the entire society must also be organized according to the characteristics of this factor of production. In particular, this special status of the **primary factor of production** will profoundly influence the societal value orientation and overall consciousness.

Third, a certain factor of production occupying the premier position implies that it possesses the capacity to "transform" into other requisite factors of production. This means that as long as one possesses it, there will naturally be no shortage of the remaining factors of production.

If this point remains somewhat unclear for the more ancient **slavery societies** (奴隶制社会) and **feudal societies** (封建社会) due to backward logistics and information dissemination (*a point I will supplement later*), it is glaringly obvious in so-called **capitalist societies** (资本主义社会). Because as long as you possess sufficient capital, acquiring land and labor is not difficult at all.

Therefore, as time progresses, when a certain factor of production occupies the premier position, a specific model of (class) society will be generated: for instance, a **slavery society** corresponding to labor, a **feudal society** corresponding to land, and a **capitalist society** corresponding to capital.

In this way, the essence of so-called class substitution is precisely the direct reflection upon social structural changes of the process where, propelled by the advancement of production, the relative status of two factors of production waxes and wanes (地位此消彼长).

For instance, a widely focused issue during the process of **early modernization and modernization** (近代化)—that is, the transition from a **feudal society** to a capitalist society—is the commercialization of land. This is, in fact, the external manifestation of the reversal in status between two means of production: land and capital.

Today, people can easily observe that the commercialization of land emerging in the late feudal stage underwent two processes. **First** was the commercialization of the *output* of the land, centrally manifested in the widespread cultivation of cash crops. **Second** was the land itself (*or more rationally, the concept of land property rights / 土地产权*) being thrown into the torrent of the market as a commodity.

If we observe Britain and Japan, we can see how the discrepancies in the completion degree of land commercialization intuitively reflect upon the trajectory of social development.

At the closing stages of the Middle Ages, Britain had already initiated the commercialization of land output (*spearheaded by the Yeomanry*). Subsequently, through several centuries of the Enclosure Movement (圈地运动)—(*which, of course, could not have been purely a market behavior; obviously, the enclosers could employ coercive administrative measures against the peasants*)—the feudal land structure formed during the Middle Ages completely disintegrated.

True, although the main driving force of the enclosures in Britain was the great landlords themselves, this did not prevent the movement from practically burying the **feudal system**. Over the past several centuries, the social order of the Middle Ages was built upon a hierarchical order reliant on land; lords of all sizes held a place within the aristocratic system precisely because they possessed their own hereditary fiefs.

However, when land itself could be merged and annexed so arbitrarily (*even if it was annexing the land of peasants*), this sacred order based on land inevitably reached its end. If relying on capital—backed by a modicum of administrative power—could acquire land exceeding that of a former baron or earl, then in what exactly did the "nobility" of these so-called feudal aristocrats reside?

Yet, if we observe Japanese society during the contemporaneous climax of the Enclosure Movement, we quickly realize the glaring difference between the two.

During the Edo period, Japan had undoubtedly achieved the commercialization of land output. We do not even need to look at cash crops; commercial behaviors based merely on the staple grain of rice had already birthed futures (期货) and candlestick charts (K线图) in Japan. The degree of commercialization could hardly be called low.

However, Edo Japan under the *Bakuh* system (幕藩体制) ultimately had the *Samurai* as its actual rulers, with the *Chigyō* system (知行制 / fief system) and feudal master-vassal relationships serving as its political bedrock. Consequently, the commercialization of *land property rights* was inevitably subjected to colossal obstruction.

Even if a wealthy merchant in Osaka possessed wealth rivaling the state, he could not possibly purchase the territory of a *Daimyo* and become a *Daimyo* himself, not even by the lowest standard of 10,000 *Koku* (万石).

It is precisely this discrepancy that allows people to intuitively feel that Britain significantly led Japan on the path of **early modernization and modernization**. Thus, Britain became the first to cross the threshold of early modernization and initiate the Industrial Revolution, whereas Japan, even after opening its doors under Western influence, still took a century fraught with errors to embark on a normal capitalist path.

In this way, we arrive at a glaringly obvious conclusion: **The essence of early modernization and modernization is to make the importance of land decline, while the importance of capital rises.**

Ludicrously, the Bolshevik regimes have completely deceived the people on this point. They proclaimed that "*the key lies in whose hands the land is in,*" and "*as long as nationalization and collectivization are implemented, everything will get better.*" These are outright lies.

Take the actual reality of the Land Reform (土改) in mainland China, for instance. Its ultimate goal was nothing more than to control the land through the Party bureaucrats (党官僚 / the latest developmental form of our country's bureaucratic system).

How does their ambition differ from those emperors—starting with Emperor Xiaowen of Northern Wei (元宏)—who attempted to implement the Equal-field system (均田) under the *Ritsuryō* (律令) system? In essence, it is the act of the bureaucracy controlling the means of production. It absolutely cannot be mentioned in the same breath as the land reform conducted by the Kuomintang (KMT) on the island of Taiwan, which ultimately propelled social progress.

In fact, the success or failure of the mainland's Land Reform can be illustrated by a highly conspicuous example: the fact that "land-based finance" (土地财政) still occupies such a critical position in the mainland's economic structure. If the importance of land itself had truly declined to a position significantly secondary to capital, this phenomenon would be impossible.

In Japan in the early 1990s, it is true that their nationwide real estate bubble had inflated to massive proportions. But even under those circumstances, who would dare say that Japan's pillar industry was real estate?

Yet in China, this is the reality. Those who do not live here find it difficult to grasp intuitively, but for those who do, it is simply far too commonplace. To coerce ordinary people into emptying the

wealth of several generations to buy a house, the Chinese government uses every trick in the book—coaxing and deceiving, using both the carrot and the stick (软硬兼施).

How many people have had their lives ruined by encountering unfinished building projects (烂尾楼)?

How many have been saddled with mortgages, living like beasts of burden (牲口) for their entire lives? Have we not seen enough of such tragedies?

What is most terrifying is that there is far too much evidence indicating that the Bolsheviks absolutely did not commit evil out of good intentions. I fear they knew from the very beginning exactly what kind of society they would get. And the mountains of corpses and seas of blood (尸山血海) were exactly what they wanted to achieve, because their privileges were built precisely upon such mountains of corpses and seas of blood.

A very direct piece of evidence is the term "**Comprador**" (买办). In modern China, this term is primarily used to refer to the bourgeoisie in colonial and semi-colonial countries who are dependent on foreign monopoly capital and directly serve imperialism. It appears as the villain in official narratives, embodying the image of the running dogs of imperialism.

However, anyone with even a slight understanding of Chinese historical literature will know that for the past millennium, this term always referred to "*the runners/errand-boys who procured goods and performed duties for the government*" (为官府采购做事的差役).

Bai Juyi's famous poem *The Old Charcoal Seller* (《卖炭翁》) describes it thus: "*Half a bolt of red silk and a length of damask, tied to the ox's head as the price of the charcoal.*" (半匹红纱一丈绡，系向牛头充炭直) This vividly depicts the scene of the *Compradors* (买办) relying on the terrifying authority of the court to extort and plunder the commoners.

Even during the Ming and Qing dynasties, when monarchical despotism was hyper-inflated, bureaucratic intellectuals did not dare to openly deny the harm brought by *Compradors*. *The Veritable Records of Emperor Xuanzong of Ming* (《明宣宗实录》) was forced to bluntly state: "*Recently, local officials, under the pretext of official business, have grown urgent in levying duties; both the rich and the poor are impoverished by the Compradors... resulting in our people lacking clothing and food, wandering destitute, and fleeing.*" (比者所司，每缘公务，急于科差，贫富困于买办…以致吾民衣食不给，转徙逃亡。)

The ludicrous part is that when Chinese intellectuals at the beginning of the last century translated the foreign concept of "those who work for the colonizers," they astonishingly used this very term—which originally reflected the tyranny of the **bureaucratic state**! I would like to ask: what exactly was their ulterior motive in doing this?

Even without counting the everyday atrocities and relatively small-scale peasant uprisings during ordinary times, just counting the few massive wars and turmoils since the initial reconstruction of the bureaucratic system in the Sui Dynasty—the turmoils of the late Sui, the An Lushan Rebellion, the turmoils of the late Tang, the turmoils of the late Yuan, the Jingnan Campaign, the social upheaval and wars of the late Ming, the Taiping Rebellion, and other regional violent movements in the late Qing—the combined unnatural deaths caused by these events alone already exceed two hundred million people.

If we add the commoners who died due to the **restoration-bureaucratic system** during those "peaceful years," the population that died unnaturally due to politics from the Sui to the Qing is sufficient to equal the total population of the present-day United States.

And these massive catastrophes were caused either by the inherent flaws of the centralized **bureaucratic state** system; or by the total collapse of society when the agricultural economy in the late stages of a dynasty could no longer even maintain its current scale; or by the complete lack of resistance to violent movements organized by religions because the local society was excessively atomized (过度原子化) (*the landmark event being the Dungan Revolt / 同治回乱*).

In their essence, they were all caused by bureaucratic restoration. Nowhere else in the world except China has seen such a staggering number of horrifying demographic implosions.

The unrecorded and unpardonable crimes (罄竹难书的罪行) and continuous agony resulting in hundreds of millions of unnatural deaths suffered by a full 50 generations over 1,300 years (*counting up to the beginning of the last century*) have been so nonchalantly glossed over!

Even if we include the total losses inflicted on China by the Japanese fascist war of aggression, the total destruction caused by *all* foreign aggressors against China from 1840 to the present does not even amount to one-tenth of the colossal material and spiritual holocaust caused by successive Chinese courts.

Furthermore, imperialist countries did not merely bring destruction to China; they inevitably brought advanced science and technology. The simplest point that even an idiot can understand is this: if the widespread use of fossil fuels brought about by industrialization had not halted environmental collapse, and if modern agriculture and medicine had not allowed people to fill their stomachs and survive diseases, how could China's population possibly have grown from 400 million in the late Qing to 1.4 billion today?

In comparison, have our country's bureaucrats genuinely ever done any enterprise beneficial to society and the common people?

They consciously and purposefully deceive the commoners, saying: "*Now the most hateful enemies are those foreign devils (洋鬼子) and fake-foreign devils (二鬼子)*. As for bureaucrats, *only* the bureaucrats who do not belong to us are bad, whereas the bureaucrats belonging to us are the vanguards of social revolution!"

4, 对于阶级社会定义的调整

过去十年来受到的欺骗让我感到尤为愤怒，我第一次直观地感受到政府能够做出多大的恶行，这在以前对我而言是难以想象的。最为可笑之处在于，真正从理论上判处这些国家死刑的并非别人，而是被视为科学社会主义的祖师爷马克思和恩格斯。例如一个十分经典的问题即“首位生产要素”问题，这被用来解释为什么人类会经历不同阶段的阶级社会。当人类社会出现剩余产品进而阶级分化以来，随着生产力的发展先后有三个生产要素分别跃居所有生产要素中的首要位置，即劳动力（这里需要指出一个细节，对于早期国家来说，剥削的主要对象应该精确的表述成“初级劳动力”而不是劳动力，前者强调纯粹的体力。因为从各种意义上说，知识本身就是劳动力的一个组成部分。我们可以想到对于青铜时代以及更早的埃及和美索不达米亚来说，虽然不乏从事技术工作的奴隶，但是那个年代先进的知识和生产技术仍然主要掌握在祭司，世俗统治者和自由民手里。如果我们粗略的把劳动力划分为初级劳动力即体力

加上智力资本即知识，情况会清晰许多），土地和资本（这就是为什么用生产要素而非生产资料这个词，因为在马克思的语境中，劳动力不属于生产资料只是生产要素，但是土地和资本都被两者包含）。

什么叫作首要位置？这对于我这样一个生活在官僚社会的人确实不是特别好说明，我的国家已经有14个世纪不处在典型的阶级社会了，毕竟在我生活的土地上天大地大不如官大。因此以我浅薄的见识来看，所谓首要位置至少包括三种内涵，将来如果有懂的人看到我的记录再斧正吧！第一，某一生产要素处于首要位置意味着其对于社会生产的贡献最大。第二，某一生产要素处于首要位置意味着生产关系需要围绕其为中心进行调整，进而整个社会也要依据该生产要素的特征进行组织，特别是首位生产要素这种特殊地位会深刻影响社会价值取向和整体意识。第三，某一生产要素处于首要位置意味着它有“转化为”其他必需的生产要素的能力，这也就是说只要有了它，其余生产要素自然就不会缺。如果说更久远的奴隶社会和封建社会这一点因为物流和信息传播落后尚且不太清晰（这一点会在后面补充），那么在所谓资本主义社会则是显然的，因为只要你有足够的资本，那么获取土地和劳力并非困难。因此随着时间推移，当某一个生产要素居于首位时就会产生特定模式的（阶级）社会，例如劳力对应的奴隶社会，土地对应的封建社会和资本对应的资本主义社会。这样一来，所谓阶级交替的本质就是随着生产进步两种生产要素地位此消彼长的过程在社会结构变化上的直接反映。

例如近代化过程中（也就是从封建社会向资本主义社会的过渡）被广泛关注到的问题，即土地的商品化问题，其实就是土地和资本两个生产资料地位发生逆转的外在表现。人们今天很容易观察从封建阶段后期产生的土地商品化经历了两个过程，首先是土地上的产出商品化，集中表现在经济作物的广泛种植；其次是土地（或者土地产权这个概念更为合理）本身被作为商品投入市场的洪流当中。如果我们观察英国和日本就能看到土地商品化完成度上的差异对社会发展进程的直观反映，英国在中世纪的结束阶段就（在约曼 Yeoman 的带领下）已经开始了土地产出的商品化，接着经过数个世纪的圈地运动（当然这不可能是纯粹的市场行为，显然圈地者对农民能够采取强硬的行政手段）中世纪形成的封建土地结构完全瓦解。诚然在英国虽然圈地的主力本身就是大地主，但这并不妨碍这一运动在事实上将埋葬封建制度。因为过去几个世纪，中世纪的社会秩序就建立在依赖土地的等级秩序上，大大小小的领主就是因为拥有自己的世袭领地而在贵族体系中有了一席之地，而当土地本身可以被如此随意的兼并的时候（哪怕是兼并农民的土地），这种基于土地的神圣秩序也不可避免地走到尽头。如果依靠资本以及背后的一点行政力量就可以获得超过曾经一个男爵、伯爵的土地，那么这些所谓的封建贵族究竟“贵”在何处呢？

但是如果我们观察圈地运动高潮同时期的日本社会，那么我们很快就会意识到两者之间的明显差别：江户时代的日本毫无疑问已经实现了土地产出的商品化，甚至不需要看那些经济作物，仅仅是基于大米这种主粮的商业行为，就已经使得日本诞生了期货和 K 线图，其商品化程度不可谓不高。然而幕藩制下的江户日本毕竟以武士作为实际统治者，以知行制和封建主从制为政治基石，土地产权的商品化必然会受到极大的阻碍。即使大坂的豪商富可敌国，他也不可能把一个有名的领地买下来然后自己成为大名，即使是以一万石的最低标准。正是这种差异让人们能够直观地感受到英国在近现代化的道路上显著地领先于日本，所以英国第一个越过近现代化的门槛并且开始了工业革命，而日本即使是在西方影响下开国之后仍然用了充满错误的一个世纪才走上正常的资本主义道路。这样一来我们就得到了一个显而易见的结论，所谓近现代化的本质就是让土地的重要性下降，而资本的重要性上升。

十分可笑的是，布尔什维克政权在这一点上完全欺骗了人民，他们声称“关键在于土地在谁手里”“只要推行国有化和集体化，一切都会好起来”，这是彻头彻尾的谎言。就拿中国大陆土改的实际情况来看，其最终目的不过是通过党官僚（我国官僚制度发展的最新形势）控制土地而已，其野心与自孝文帝元宏开始那些试图在律令之下实施均田的皇帝有何异哉？本质上就是让官僚控制生产资料的行为，更不能与台湾国民党在岛内所进行的最终推动了社会进步的土改相提并论。实际上大陆土改的成败有一个非常显然的事例可以说明，那就是土地财政仍然在大陆的经济结构中占有如此重要的位置，而假如土地本身的重要性已经下降到显著次于资本的位置，这种现象是不可能发生的。在 90 年代初的日本，的确，他们全国范围内房地产泡沫已经膨胀到极大，但是就是在这种情况下，有谁敢说日本当年的支柱产业是房地产？但是在中国，这就是现实，不活在这里的人难以直观体会，但是对生活在这里的人来说简直不要太常见。中国政府为了让老百姓掏空几代人的财富去买房子可谓连哄带骗，软硬兼施，不知道多少人遇到烂尾楼使生活毁于一旦，不知道多少人背上房贷如同牲口一样过一辈子，这样的事情难道见得还少吗？

1949 年以来，中国的社会制度到底有没有发生什么有益的变革，这在今天是一个值得思考的问题。帝制时期延续了 2000 年的户籍制度今天居然还存在，人民连自由迁徙的权力都无法保证，不同地区的户口之间享有的权利差异竟然如此之大，这不是“封建残余”又是什么？把老百姓视为随意驱使的牲口和经济发展的燃料，驱使他们付出如此之多却用如此之少的残羹剩饭予以打发，以“人矿”（中国互联网用语，意为中国政府将老百姓视为矿物和化石燃料一样的资源）丰富为傲，视人力成本低廉为竞争优势，将人民能够忍受极其恶劣的环境却只获得可怜的报酬宣传为“民族禀赋”，这不是奴隶制残余是什么？此间可有半分现代性（modernity）可言？我在十月份的时候就应该想到，既然中国在封建化进行了一半的时候就拐入了官僚化的死路，那么其社会表现必然也就充其量处于奴隶制社会和封建社会之间偏向后者一点的位置，充其量是普遍使用了来自西方的现在技术罢了，至于资本主义社会根本就是放眼望不到的东西，难道现在的大陆有多少资本主义的特征？

而最为可怖的是，有太多证据表明这绝不是布尔什维克好心干了坏事，他们恐怕最开始就知道自己将会得到一个什么样的社会，而且他们想要实现的就是这样的尸山血海，因为他们的特权就是建立在这样的尸山血海上。一个非常直接的证据就是所谓的“买办”一词，这个词在现在的中国被主要用来指在殖民地半殖民地国家中依附于外国垄断资本并直接为帝国主义服务的资产阶级，作为官方叙事中的反派，而且是作为帝国主义的走狗的形象出现。而任何人只要对中国的历史文献有一点了解，就会明白这个词在过去千百年里指的都是“为官府采购做事的差役”，白居易的名诗《卖炭翁》中的“半匹红纱一丈绡，系向牛头充炭直”写的就是买办仗着朝廷之威对平民百姓巧取豪夺的景象。即使是在君主专制高度膨胀的明清时期，官僚知识分子也不敢明面上否认买办所带来的危害，《明宣宗实录》也不得不直言道“比者所司，每缘公务，急于科差，贫富困于买办…以致吾民衣食不给，转徙逃亡。”可笑的是，上个世纪初的中国知识分子在翻译“为殖民者做事的人”这一外来概念的时候竟然用了这个原本反映官僚国家暴政的词汇，我倒想问问这到底是什么居心呢？

即使不算那些平常时日里面日日夜夜的暴行和比较小的农民起义，从隋朝初步重建官僚体制以来仅仅算几场大规模的战乱：隋末战乱，安史之乱，唐末战乱，元末战乱，靖难之役，明末社会动荡和战乱以及太平天国运动以及清末其他地方暴力运动，加起来造成非正常死亡的人口就已经超过了两个亿。而

如果算上那些“太平岁月”里因为复辟官僚制度死去的百姓，从隋至清因为政治非正常死亡的人口足以与现在美国的总人口相当。而这些大难不是由于官僚集权国家体制的固有缺陷所导致，就是王朝后期农业经济连维持当前规模都不可行而造成的社会总崩溃，或者因为当地社会过度原子化而对宗教组织下的暴力运动完全没有抵抗能力（具有标志性的就是同治回乱），就其本质而言皆为官僚复辟所导致的，全世界除了中国以外没有任何一个地方发生过如此之多骇人听闻的人口剧减。在 1300 年间（是算到上世纪初为止）整整 50 代人所遭遇过的造成数亿人非正常死亡的罄竹难书的罪行以及持续不断的苦难，竟然如此轻描淡写地被抹开了，就是把日本法西斯侵华战争给中国造成的总损失算上，所有外国侵略者在从 1840 年至今所对中国造成的总破坏，也远不及中国历代朝廷所造成的物质和精神上巨大浩劫的十分之一。再说帝国主义国家对中国也不仅仅是造成破坏，他们必定带来了先进的科学技术，最简单的连白痴都能明白的一点是，如果没有工业化带来的化石燃料的广泛使用遏制了环境崩溃，现代的农业和医学让人能够吃饱肚子并且不至于面对疾病束手无策，中国的人口怎么可能从清末的四亿增长到现在的十四亿？相比之下，我国的官僚真的有做过什么有益于社会，有益于百姓的事业吗？他们有意识有目的地欺骗老百姓说：现在最可恨的敌人是那些洋鬼子和二鬼子，至于官僚，只有那些不属于我们的官僚才是坏，而属于我们的官僚都是社会革命的先锋。